Pragmatism displaces ambition at the COPs

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【メール原文】

The era of grand multilateral ambition at UN environmental summits is giving way to a messier landscape of bilateral deals, private-sector partnership||||||||||||||||

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Adaptation and bilateral deals will define new UN environmental era

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Countries will sideline formal UN environmental negotiations at this year’s UN climate and biodiversity summits (COP31 and COP17) in favor of unilateral measures and smaller, issue-specific coalitions, as governments take a more pragmatic approach to balancing economic growth with long-term resilience.
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Countries will make climate and biodiversity finance commitments largely to advance national objectives rather than principled international obligations, to the detriment of least developed countries in need of concessional support.
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Adaptation and resilience will become the defining objectives of UN environmental processes, as climate impacts accelerate.

The era of grand multilateral ambition at UN environmental summits is giving way to a messier landscape of bilateral deals, private-sector partnerships, and geopolitical maneuvering. This year's trifecta of biodiversity, climate, and water conferences will test whether issue-specific coalitions can fill the gap left by weakening multilateral frameworks.

For the private sector, the stakes are high across all three negotiations: from the International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB)'s looming decision on standalone nature disclosures at the biodiversity summit (COP17), to carbon market integrity and clean energy coalitions at the climate summit (COP31), to new water stewardship accountability frameworks at the UN Water Conference. Meanwhile, the geopolitical dimension is sharpening, with China leveraging its "electrostate" status to build political partnerships through clean energy markets. Finally, the coming High Seas Treaty COP in 2027 may prove to be the most consequential UN environmental process in years.

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María José (Majo) Valverde
Senior Analyst, Nature
Valverde@eurasiagroup.net
EG Sustainability

sustainability@eurasiagroup.net

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